

UNIVERSITY OF BRIGHTON Assessment brief

Module code and title:	FA583 – Financial Accounting and Reporting
Module Leader name:	Tapiwa Gande
Module Leader email:	T.Gande@brighton.ac.uk
Assessment task title:	Coursework assignment – Task 1
Weighting:	30%
Individual/group work:	Individual
Word Count/equivalent:	1,000 words
Module learning outcomes assessed:	<i>LO2 Apply understanding in both practical and computational situations and in identifying conceptual problems.</i> <i>LO5 To develop the capacity for independent and self-managed learning.</i> <i>LO6 To locate, extract and analyse data from multiple sources, including the acknowledgement and referencing of sources.</i>
Submission date & time:	Date: Friday 27 March 2026 Time: 10.00
Return of marks and feedback date:	25th April 2026
Submission format:	<i>Turnitin submission</i>

Use of Generative AI within this assessment task (delete rows as appropriate)

'RAG' Rating



Red - AI prohibited

Use of Generative AI tools is prohibited beyond support for checking spelling and grammar.

Details of Assessment Task: what am I required to do?

This assignment is to be based around the financial statements of a company of your choice from a list of companies provided. Company financial statements will include the Statement of Financial Position, the Statement of Profit or Loss and Other Comprehensive Income and the Statement of Cash Flows. The list of companies in selected sectors is available at the end of this brief for students to choose a company for their assignment.

You are required to prepare 1,000 words report to evaluate the financial performance and position of the company based upon the published financial statements of that company for a three-year period.

The Assignment

Each student will perform a financial analysis of a UK company listed on the London Stock Exchange. A marking rubric is provided below to give you a guide on how marks will be awarded. Company financial statements will include the Statement of Financial Position, the Statement of Profit or Loss and Other Comprehensive Income and the Statement of Cash Flows. All calculations are to be done using Excel and the quantitative information presented in a worksheet format.

Details of Assessment Task: what am I required to do?

1. Input the financial statements for the **three years** into a spreadsheet.
2. Using the statements, you have prepared, compute the financial ratios to assess two main areas of performance, related to **profitability** and **liquidity (short term and long term/solvency)**. You should be able to calculate a **minimum** of 8 ratios in total [no less than 3 ratios in each area of performance to enable you to comment on the performance of the company]. All ratios can be found in your textbook.
3. **Written Report:** Prepare a summary report that includes a basic profile of the company and identifies its chief competitors, products, markets, etc. The report should **critically analyse** the use of the calculated financial ratios to evaluate company performance in each performance area. "Your report should be in paragraph form and should be submitted in an MS Word document."

Important Note:

The calculations are meant to provide a strong basis for your analysis. However, on their own, calculations will identify some issues that require further investigation. Therefore, it is expected that in order to provide a meaningful analysis of the company's financial performance, you will make use of other information from various sources, e.g. annual report, company website, industry publications.

 CRITICAL THINKER	• Critical reading skills • Analysing literature • Deciding what to include and how to use literature
 SOLUTION-FOCUSED INNOVATOR	• Problem solving • Assimilating information
 CONFIDENT COMMUNICATOR	• Report-writing skills • Communicating technical concepts clearly and succinctly
 CREATIVE AND CONFIDENT USER OF DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES	• Using technology to find, interpret, evaluate, manage and share information and data

Appendix: Marking criteria:

The marking criteria used to mark your work are presented below:

How will your assignment be marked?

This gives you details of the elements you need to demonstrate within the assessment task and their weighting towards the total mark. Full marking criteria, showing details of the standards against which performance will be judged for each grade level are available in Appendix A and in the assessment/marks area of My Studies.

You can use these to evaluate your own work and consider your grade before you submit.

The marking criteria are aligned to and informed by the [University marking descriptors](#)

Criteria	Weighting
Understanding of chosen company and industry	15%
Identification and presentation of financial information including ratios	20%
Ability to take in and fully understand financial information	10%
Analysis and interpretation of financial information and ratios	35%
Report writing including grammar and relevant referencing	10%
Summary and conclusions	10%

Good Academic Conduct:

Please see the General Examination and Assessment Regulations ([GEAR](#)) and your course handbook for good academic conduct guidelines and details of academic misconduct regulations including plagiarism.

Moderation:

All summative assessments are subject to the application of appropriate internal moderation procedures.

Moderation is an overarching term to describe the processes that take place after initial marking to provide an element of independent scrutiny on the judgement of the first marker and ensure the fairness, reliability and consistency of marking against the criteria.

Internal moderation is carried out by the school and followed by external moderation by the external examiner.

What support is available to help you with this assignment?	
Formative Assessment Task and Feedback: Feedback on relevant topic areas will be provided in response to in-class activities and discussions.	
Assessment Briefing and Support workshop / taught sessions:	See Module Roadmap for details.
Individual tutorials with your module seminar tutor in tutor's office hours or by arrangement:	Contact Tapiwa Gande by e-mail or on Teams to arrange
Questions about the assignment brief (up to 2 working days before hand-in):	Contact Tapiwa Gande by e-mail or on Teams
Resources in assessment support folder in My Studies:	Resources are available via the Assessment & Marks folder in MyStudies, the module Reading List, and the topic areas within the Study Materials folder in MyStudies.
Brighton Student Skills Hub – people, resources and guides to help you with academic writing, research, presentation skills, time management, maths and stats, digital skills and more....	Brighton Student Skills Hub (sharepoint.com)
SBL Academic Skills Tutor – one to one tutorials for support with understanding, structuring and writing / presenting assignments.	Book a tutorial by email: c.l.roche@brighton.ac.uk Elm House Tuesday 1pm-4pm Online on Teams: Thursdays 9.30-12.30
Writing Advisory Service - feedback from an experienced academic tutor on the organisation and clarity of your ideas, academic style and frequent language mistakes:	Writing Advisory Service (WAS) (sharepoint.com)
Student Support and Guidance Tutor – for support with wellbeing, time management, financial worries and more:	SSGT-bbs@brighton.ac.uk
Technical Support – any technical issues submitting an assignment via My studies:	Email servicedesk@brighton.ac.uk or call 01273 644 444

Extensions:

An application for an extension to a deadline should be made by using the University proforma ARGEAR 1, [Extension to deadline Form](#) (you will find this in your assessment support folder).

The form must be submitted for approval to the **Course Leader** along with independent supporting evidence 48 hours before the original submission deadline.

There are very strict rules about what constitutes grounds for an extension.

For full details of the extension procedure and detailed guidance, see course handbook or in Section B of [GEAR](#)

Additional considerations (formerly Mitigating Circumstances).

If due to exceptional circumstances outside your control (i.e., unforeseen and unavoidable), you are absent from the assessment (including examination), fail to submit or undertake assessed work, fail to submit work by the deadline, including any agreed extensions (late submission) or you feel that your performance in all or part of an assessment is under-representative of your standard performance, you may submit a request for additional considerations.

Where an additional considerations application is accepted, the Course Examination Board will take your exceptional circumstances into consideration when deciding on the appropriate outcome.

Full details can be found in GEAR (Section B.5). [Additional Consideration \(sharepoint.com\)](#)

What support is available to help you with this assignment?**Formative Assessment Task and Feedback:**

Feedback on relevant topic areas will be provided in response to in-class activities and discussions.

Assessment Briefing and Support workshop / taught sessions:	See Module Roadmap for details.
Individual tutorials with your module seminar tutor in tutor's office hours or by arrangement:	Contact Tapiwa Gande by e-mail or on Teams to arrange
Questions about the assignment brief (up to 2 working days before hand-in):	Contact Tapiwa Gande by e-mail or on Teams
Resources in assessment support folder in My Studies:	Resources are available via the Assessment & Marks folder in MyStudies, the module Reading List, and the topic areas within the Study Materials folder in MyStudies.
Brighton Student Skills Hub – people, resources and guides to help you with academic writing, research, presentation skills, time management, maths and stats, digital skills and more....	Brighton Student Skills Hub (sharepoint.com)
SBL Academic Skills Tutor – one to one tutorials for support with understanding, structuring and writing / presenting assignments.	Book a tutorial by email: c.i.roche@brighton.ac.uk Elm House Tuesday 1pm-4pm Online on Teams: Thursdays 9.30-12.30
Writing Advisory Service - feedback from an experienced academic tutor on the organisation and clarity of your ideas, academic style and frequent language mistakes:	Writing Advisory Service (WAS) (sharepoint.com)

Student Support and Guidance Tutor – for support with wellbeing, time management, financial worries and more:	SSGT-bbs@brighton.ac.uk
Technical Support – any technical issues submitting an assignment via My studies:	Email servicedesk@brighton.ac.uk or call 01273 644 444
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Schedule of companies in the Retail sector

Company
ASOS
Burberry
DFS Furniture
Dunelm
Greggs
Halfords
Inchcape
JD Sports
Kingfisher
Marks and Spencer
Morrison (W)
Mothercare
Next
Pets at Home
J. Sainsburys
W H Smith
Sports Direct International
Ted Baker
Tesco
Topps Tiles

Schedule of companies in the Media sector

Company
Bloomsbury Publishing
Euromoney Institutional Investor
Informa
ITV
Just Eat
Pearson
RELX
Rightmove
WPP
Wilmington
YouGov
Thomson Reuters
Amazon Prime Video
Telegraph Media Group

Schedule of companies in the Leisure sector

Company
Cineworld
Domino's Pizza
easyJet
Greene King
GVC Holdings
Merlin Entertainments
Mitchell & Butlers
SSP Group
TUI Group, UK
J D Wetherspoon
Whitbread
William Hill
Thomas Cook
John Lewis
Starbucks

Appendix – Level 5 Marking Descriptors	
Mark	Level 5 Marking Descriptor
80-100 (A+) First class/Distinction: An outstanding response to the task All criteria have been achieved to an exceptionally high level	1. Exceptional and authoritative knowledge and critical understanding of theories, principles and concepts within the area/s of study, the ways in which these are developed via enquiry and the provisional nature of this knowledge. 2. The communication of work using the techniques of the discipline/s across a range of contexts, including structure, coherence, accuracy and presentation (written, visual and/or technical aspects) is exemplary throughout 3. Exceptional identification and analysis of problems, demonstrating high levels of originality in formulating evidence-based approaches to solving them 4. Consistently exceptional analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis, and evaluation to critically appraise arguments and make judgements within the context of the discipline/s 5. Consistently excellent levels of decision-making within complex contexts as well as demonstrating excellent initiative and personal responsibility 6. Exceptional identification of own learning needs, drawing on a range of current research, development and professional materials
70-79 (A A-) First class/Distinction: An excellent response to the task All criteria have been achieved to a high standard and many at an exceptionally high level	1. Excellent, in-depth knowledge and critical understanding of theories, principles and concepts within the area/s of study, the ways in which these are developed via enquiry and the provisional nature of this knowledge. 2. The communication of work using the techniques of the discipline across a range of contexts, including structure, coherence, accuracy and presentation (written, visual and/or technical aspects) is of very high quality throughout 3. Excellent identification and analysis of problems, demonstrating high levels of originality in formulating evidence-based approaches to solving them 4. Consistently excellent analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis, and evaluation to critically appraise arguments and make judgements within the context of the discipline/s 5. Consistently very high levels of decision-making within complex contexts as well as demonstrating excellent initiative and personal responsibility 6. Excellent identification of own learning needs, drawing on a range of current research, development and professional materials

60-69 (B+ B B-) Upper Second class/ Merit: A good to very good response to the task All criteria have been met fully at a good or a very good standard	1. Good to very good knowledge and critical understanding of theories, principles and concepts within the area/s of study, the ways in which these are developed via enquiry and the provisional nature of this knowledge 2. The communication of work using the techniques of the discipline across a range of contexts, including structure, coherence, accuracy and presentation (written, visual and/or technical aspects) is of high quality throughout 3. Good to very good identification and analysis of problems, demonstrating high levels of rigour in formulating evidence-based approaches to solving them 4. Consistently good analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis, and evaluation to critically appraise arguments and make judgements within the context of the discipline/s 5. Consistently high levels of decision-making within complex contexts as well as demonstrating excellent initiative and personal responsibility 6. Very good identification of own learning needs, drawing on a range of current research, development and professional materials
50-59 (C+ C C-) Lower Second class/Pass: A sound, competent response to the task All criteria have been met and some may have been achieved at a good standard	1. Sound knowledge and critical understanding of theories, principles and concepts within the area/s of study, the ways in which these are developed via enquiry and the provisional nature of this knowledge. 2. The communication of work using the techniques of the discipline across a range of contexts, including structure, coherence, accuracy and presentation (written, visual and/or technical aspects) is sound/appropriate 3. Sound identification and analysis of problems, demonstrating an appropriate approach to formulating evidence-based solutions 4. Some evidence of analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis, and evaluation to critically appraise arguments and make judgements within the context of the discipline/s 5. Demonstrates some level of decision-making within complex contexts as well as some ability to show initiative and personal responsibility 6. Sound identification of own learning needs, drawing on a range of current research, development and professional materials

40-49 (D+ D D-) Third class/Pass: An adequate, but weak response to the task All criteria have just been met	1. Adequate but limited knowledge, with little critical understanding, of theories, principles and concepts within the area/s of study, the ways in which these are developed via enquiry and the provisional nature of this knowledge. 2. The communication of work using the techniques of the discipline across a range of contexts, including structure, coherence, accuracy and presentation (written, visual and/or technical aspects) is adequate and may contain inaccuracies 3. Adequate but limited identification and analysis of problems, with some limitations in formulating evidence-based approaches to solving them 4. Limited evidence of analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis, and evaluation to critically appraise arguments and make judgements within the context of the discipline/s 5. Demonstrates limited level of decision-making within complex contexts as well and little ability to show initiative and personal responsibility 6. Limited identification of own learning needs, drawing on a range of current research, development and professional materials
30- 39 (E+ E E-) Fail: An unsatisfactory response to the task One or more of the criteria have not been met	1. Little knowledge of, and lack of critical understanding of theories, principles and concepts within the area/s of study, the ways in which these are developed via enquiry and the provisional nature of this knowledge. 2. The communication of work using the techniques of the discipline across a range of contexts, including structure, coherence, accuracy and presentation (written, visual and/or technical aspects) is poor and may contain inaccuracies 3. Little identification and analysis of problems, and a lack of evidence-based approaches to solving them 4. Little evidence of analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis, and evaluation to critically appraise arguments and make judgements within the context of the discipline/s 5. Demonstrates limited level of decision-making within complex contexts as well and little ability to show initiative and personal responsibility 6. Limited/little identification of own learning needs, drawing on a range of current research, development and professional materials
10-29 (F+ F) Fail: An unsatisfactory response to the task Most of the criteria have not been met	1. Very limited knowledge of, and lack of critical understanding of theories, principles and concepts within the area/s of study, the ways in which these are developed via enquiry and the provisional nature of this knowledge. 2. The communication of work using the techniques of the discipline across a range of contexts, including structure, coherence, accuracy and presentation (written, visual and/or technical aspects) is very poor and contains inaccuracies 3. Lack of identification and analysis of problems, and no evidence-based approaches to solving them 4. Extremely limited evidence of analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis, and evaluation to critically appraise arguments and make judgements within the context of the discipline/s 5. Demonstrates very limited level of decision-making within complex contexts as well and little/no ability to show initiative and personal responsibility 6. Very limited identification of own learning needs, drawing on a range of current research, development and professional materials

0-9 (F-) Fail: An unsatisfactory response to the task Almost none of the criteria have been met	1. Almost no knowledge or critical understanding of theories, principles and concepts within the area/s of study, the ways in which these are developed via enquiry and the provisional nature of this knowledge. 2. The communication of work using the techniques of the discipline across a range of contexts, including structure, coherence, accuracy and presentation (written, visual and/or technical aspects) is very poor and contains inaccuracies 3. No identification or analysis of problems 4. No evidence of analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis, and evaluation to critically appraise arguments and make judgements within the context of the discipline/s 5. No evidence of decision-making within complex contexts as well and no ability to show initiative and personal responsibility 6. No identification of own learning needs, drawing on a range of current research, development and professional materials
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